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M/M
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Relationships:
Mydei/Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail)Chrysos Heir Members & Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail)
Characters:
Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail)Mydei (Honkai: Star Rail)Aglaea (Honkai: Star Rail)Tribbie (Honkai: Star Rail)Castorice (Honkai: Star Rail)Anaxa (Honkai: Star Rail)Hyacine (Honkai: Star Rail)Cipher (Honkai: Star Rail)Hysilens (Honkai: Star Rail)Cerydra (Honkai: Star Rail)Dan Heng (Honkai: Star Rail)March 7th (Honkai: Star Rail)Trailblazer (Honkai: Star Rail)
Additional Tags:
AngstHeavy AngstAngst and FeelsAngst with a Happy EndingEventual Happy EndingIntrospectionSelf-IndulgentSelf-HatredSelf-Worth IssuesImplied/Referenced Suicidal ThoughtsPhainon is Called Khaslana (Honkai: Star Rail)Phainon Needs a Hug (Honkai: Star Rail)Everyone Needs a HugEveryone Loves Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail)MemoriesSelf-SacrificePost-CanonPost-Amphoreus Trailblaze Missions (Honkai: Star Rail)Chrysos Heirs as Found Family (Honkai: Star Rail)Found FamilyTrue LoveSoulmatesPainGrief/MourningPOV Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail)Phainon-centric (Honkai: Star Rail)Hurt Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail)Emotional HurtThere Is No Word For Beta In The Kremnoan LanguageYearning Mydei (Honkai: Star Rail)Mydei is Soft for Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail)Other Additional Tags to Be Added
Language:
English

null
Someone To Stay - Starsirony - 崩坏：星穹铁道
Organization for Transformative Worksnull
Beloved.

Such a gentle, foolish word.

A word meant for kindred spirits who are allowed to live long enough to grow old together. Not for someone who keeps murdering the man he loves across millions of dying worlds.

I imagined once calling you my beloved.

I used to think that if I endured enough, if I suffered enough, maybe I would earn that future. Someday. Far away.

Now, I understand the truth.

There is no version of me who deserves to stand beside you in the light.

Only the one who drags you into darkness, again and again, and feels devoid over it.

I used to whisper apologies.

Do you remember?

Of course you don't. You never get to remember.

It is a blessing that you do not know of this.

I would hold you while the light left your eyes and I would beg forgiveness you could not give, promising things I could never keep. I told myself that if I kept saying sorry, if I kept whispering prayers with my lips of deceit, then maybe I had not become something unforgivable yet.

Somewhere along the way, I stopped apologizing.

Not because I stopped being guilty, no.

The word sorry became too small for what I have become.

. . .

There was nothing.

No light.

No darkness.

No sound.

No feeling.

Just nothing.

It was quieter than death, yet it did not feel like living either.

He did not know how long he remained there. There was no concept of time in this place. No body to feel pain. No lungs to breathe air with. No eyes to open. No thoughts coherent enough to form.

Only absence.

Sometimes, there would be the faintest sensation of drifting.

Like fragments scattered endlessly through cold water, separated yet not too far away from each other.

But, even that would disappear.

Nothing remained long enough to stay. Everything dissolved before it could become real.

A memory would flicker—

Golden sunlight over wheat fields, feeling the dirt underneath his feet with laughter like windchimes echoing across the area.

—and then vanish instantly.

A feeling—

Warmth against his chest, not as unbearable as the heat that burned through him for countless cycles. So much gentler. Kinder. Loving.

—gone before he understood it.

A voice—

Full of love. Full of grief.

—disappearing immediately into the emptiness.

There was nothing he could do about it. No sense of direction for himself. No thought and reason to do anything at all.

So, he did nothing.

He remained there.

Drifting off endlessly.

. . .

I think I understand monsters now.

They are not creatures born vile and disgusting. They are not things that delight in the endless bloodshed.

Monsters are the ones who keep doing the unforgivable while knowing exactly that the atrocities they commit are unforgivable.

Monsters remember every face. Every scream. Every pair of eyes that once trusted them with all their heart and soul.

And they keep going anyway.

That is what I am, Mydei.

Not your Deliverer.

Not your supposed Dawn.

Not the man you loved who has walked by your side every time in every cycle once.

Just a pair of hands that keeps ending your life. Each and every single time.

A monster.

I want to laugh when I think about it. If this is what salvation requires, then salvation is only another word for cruelty.

Yet, I still keep going.

There are moments… small, treacherous moments, when I imagine a world where none of this is happening.

A world where I never learn the truth.

Where I never pick up the sword.

Where you and I are simply… people.

Would we have met each other in that life?

Maybe you would be living happier then.

. . .

Days passed.

. . .

Weeks.

. . .

Years.

. . .

No… perhaps only seconds.

. . .

There was no way to know.

The living world moved somewhere impossibly far away from him. A distant place beyond reach that he was not aware of.

Something warm would brush against the emptiness from time to time.

A pulse.

Tiny.

Weak.

It came and went.

At first, it meant nothing.

He could not understand it. Could not recognize it. Did not know if it.

But, every time it appeared, the nothingness for a moment seemed… less cold. Less numb. Less empty.

A faint hum beneath the void.

Steady and waiting.

Sometimes the hum hurt.

It was as if something pulled gently at broken pieces that were himself that no longer fit together properly.

The sensation repeated endlessly within the nothingness.

Suddenly, for just a moment… no matter how barely felt it had been… it stayed. Not long. Only slightly longer than before.

But, now… it was warm.

A hand against his chest. A forehead resting on his own. The sensation of being held.

He did not understand it.

But, something inside the emptiness loosened faintly in turn.

The warmth vanished almost immediately afterward. Yet, traces of it lingered.

That had never happened before.

He wanted to feel that again.

Feel.

Just one more time.

It would come and go, more and more, within the vast nothingness he stayed within.

There were moments where sensations across his being began surfacing more. In every moment that it did, it burned within him.

Flashes.

Pieces.

Not coherent. Never coherent.

Fire.

Screaming.

Golden blood flowing away.

The ichor soaking through pale hands.

Pieces of a body, crackling apart.

A sword.

A book.

A set of tarot cards.

A golden thread.

A flying rocket.

An antila flower.

An eyepatch.

A tiny, flying pegasus.

A coin.

A violin.

A crown made of flames.

A vine-threaded spear.

A red umbrella.

A gauntleted hand, reaching out, toward him.

Ash falling endlessly from a ruined sky.

Cries. Wails. Sobs.

Someone speaking his name.

His name—

Then, before he could bring himself to reach out more, the memories would shatter before completing themselves.

He could not understand any of it. Could not connect one fragment to another. For him, thinking in itself was impossible. He could not feel nor do anything at all.

He was too…

Exhausted.

… he did not know.

And yet, something was changing. Very slowly, but surely.

The void no longer swallowed everything immediately.

Tiny things remained behind now.

A sensation. A touch. A hum.

A pulse.

The faint awareness, a scarce part, only a small bit, that something existed beyond nothingness.

He did not understand it.

He could not understand it.

But, somewhere deep within the fractured ruins of himself, broken pieces instinctively drifted toward that warmth. Toward that pulse.

It was the only guidance he had within this void.

. . .

Do you know what the most dangerous part of my distant dream is?

It isn't peace by itself.

It's how ordinary it feels.

I dream of days within that reality, even in its impossibilities, even with what I have done, where I am waking beside you.

I imagine arguing with you about nothing at all. I imagine you complaining that I steal the blankets every time we go to sleep together. I imagine braiding your hair the way you always pretend to hate yet secretly love.

The worst part isn't the continuous killing.

It's that within every cycle… some part of you still loves me.

Even when you don't know why.

Even when fate twists everything cruelly.

Even when the world burns all around us.

You look at me like I am something worth choosing.

And I break you for it.

Again and again and again and again.

If there is an afterlife waiting for me that is not Styxia at the end of all this, I hope it is nothing but that moment repeated forever.

Your eyes realizing what I've done, over and over, without an end.

That would be fair.

More than fair.

. . .

Pain started to become clear to him the more he moved toward the warmth.

It hurt.

It really did hurt.

The exhaustion reached deeper than what one's body or mind could experience.

The agony of it all felt woven into existence itself.

As if he had been here for far too long.

As if he had been carrying the weight forever.

As if he had spent an eternity dragging himself forward through worlds that kept dying in his hands.

Flashes continued to tear through the emptiness.

All parts of himself that he was made of recoiled every time, if that motion was possible at all.

Again.

Again.

Again.

There was too much pain. Too much pain. Pain, pain, pain—

Would the pain only become worse the more he tried to reach out to this pulse?

Fragments that had once been more distant than close suddenly drifted closer together in the void just for a moment, away from the warmth, pulled by shared anguish.

Enough.

Please.

No more.

Living on had always brought pain. It always had. Hadn't it?

Rest.

The sudden thought spread through him, enough for him to hold onto easier.

Rest.

No more blood. No more destruction. No more cycles.

No more watching everyone die.

No more killing everyone with your own hands.

Grief.

Longing.

Guilt.

Regret.

Love.

Love?

He could not hold those feelings properly. They overloaded him.

It scattered him further apart suddenly, the agony becoming far too much for him to handle.

Another flash erupted, this time, much clearer than ever before.

The feeling of a spine breaking beneath a jagged blade.

A man of dull amber eyes, dead in his bloodsoaked arms.

Sobbing hoarse apologies against his blonde hair.

Something inside him started to scream within the void.

Monster.

Monster, monster, monster—

Another memory.

Another death.

Another reset.

Another timeline ending while he remained.

Always forced forward.

Always alive.

Alive.

The fragments seemed to break apart further.

No more. Please, no more.

The exhaustion became unbearable then, wrapping around him and drowning him further into nothingness, thoughts breaking apart.

If he stopped now… if he let go… there would be no more pain in his way.

No more weight of the world on his shoulders.

No grief. No anguish. No loneliness.

He would be… free.

The thought frightened some parts of him. But, other fragments leaned toward it desperately.

Because wasn't this enough? Hadn't he already given everything? What more remained of him to sacrifice? What would living do any good for him?

He completed his purpose. There was no use for him anymore. He was not needed.

The void around him pulsed softly.

Slowly, almost terrifyingly so with much ease, pieces of him began loosening further. In a way, accepting dissolution. Preparing to finally disappear.

This was it, wasn't it?

Just let go.

You've done enough.

Rest.

He wanted to rest.

. . .

I am so tired, Mydei.

Not the kind of tiredness that sleep can ever fix.

It's an exhaustion that lives so deep in the bones. In the soul. Whatever fragile thing inside me keeps choosing to continue this ordeal.

Sometimes, I wonder what would happen if I stopped.

If I let the world end. If I let everyone die. If I finally chose rest over everything else.

The thought is so tempting that it frightens me.

I know, with terrible certainty, if it were only your life against the world… if it was only you that mattered and not the fate of the entire universe at hand… if I actually had a choice… I would choose you.

Every time.

That is the truth I can never allow myself to live.

So instead, I keep becoming the thing that destroys you, because loving you would end everything that we're both fighting for.

What a cruel design.

To make the purest love I have ever known the one thing I must always betray.

If there is any mercy left in this wretched existence of mine… it is this.

You will never remember these words. You will never know how weak I am.

How often I almost stop. How desperately I want a life where I can love you without everyone's blood, including yours, on my hands.

You will only remember whatever version of me survives to the end.

I hope… selfishly, greedily, impossibly… that somewhere, in some final world I cannot yet see… there is a version of us that escapes all of this.

A comfortable house.

Quiet mornings.

The endless wheat fields.

Your hand in mine without the fear of ever losing it.

And maybe, if the universe is kinder than it has ever been… you will call me your husband.

Not because I earned it. Not because I deserve it.

But because, despite everything, you still love me anyway.

If I cannot give you a life without pain, the least I can do is keep you from seeing how completely I have already fallen.

Please, let my regret reach you.

Forgive the person I am.

Forgive my misdeeds.

Forgive me.

Please don't forgive me.

I will keep saving this world. Even if it means losing you until I can no longer have you for all eternity.

Goodbye, my love.

I will see you tomorrow.

. . .

The world was ending quietly.

An ending that was starting a beginning that came anew.

Sounds that rang all across the world before them were distant and muffled beneath the unbearable ringing inside his skull.

He could barely hear anything anymore.

The fire inside his body had long since surpassed what any living being should have been capable of enduring.

Millions of deaths.

Millions of worlds ending.

Millions of iterations of destruction.

Millions of versions of his loved ones dying, over and over and over—

Something caught him before he hit the ground.

Hands. Warm hands.

Voices burst through the muffled barrier surrounding his consciousness, every word a strain for him to be able to listen to distinguish.

But, he did.

He still tried.

“Phainon!”

“Mydei, careful—”

“He’s burning up… the fire… it won’t stop!”

“We need more help as fast as possible! Now!”

A part of him recognized those voices. Truly, he did. Even as awareness slipped through his fingers like water, his heart would recognize each and every one of them from everywhere.

The Chrysos Heirs.

They were all alive.

Alive.

The realization alone nearly broke him apart completely.

They survived. They can live.

The thought echoed weakly through the ruin of his mind.

Amphoreus still existed. The Black Tide was gone. Irontomb was gone.

After 33,550,336 cycles… it was finally over.

Over.

The world continued to blur in and out of existence around him.

For brief moments, few in those bare seconds, he saw his surroundings with unbearable sharpness. The ruined battlefield collapsing underneath fading crimson darkness. The ash drifting through the air like the snow back in Aidonia. The remnants of the virus dissipating away, bit by bit.

People’s faces looking back at his direction. Toward his way. Down at him.

And they all looked—

Something deep inside his chest tore suddenly.

He gasped soundlessly, breath ragged and hoarse.

Everything smeared together again into shapeless color and static in the next second before he could even breathe.

He needed to say something. Needed to reassure them. Needed to comfort them. Needed to tell them—

What?

The thoughts in his mind were slipping too quickly now.

He tried to move his hand, yet it barely twitched before agony exploded through his entire body. He could not feel his fingers properly anymore, nor could he not feel where his legs were.

His very being was unraveling before him.

The pain was indescribable.

Something was happening to him.

What was it?

What was going to become of him?

Another rupture tore through him., and he choked out weakly.

Suddenly, he could feel it.

Feel himself coming apart from the inside.

Like threads snapping one by one, memories within his mind were ripping loose. His own self being torn apart into pieces.

The countless fragments of himself accumulated across millions of cycles breaking beneath the strain all at once.

Too many deaths. Too much grief. Too many versions of himself forced together into one existence never meant to endure this long. Never meant to live for an eternity and beyond.

It was as if his soul was collapsing under its own weight.

Perhaps that was the case.

He could barely feel the same warm hands that continued to cradle him against the crackling flesh of his body.

He forced his eyes to follow his command. To open up and look back at the person that stared back at him, the grip only getting more firmer with every passing second.

Blonde hair, blurred into pale gold with crimson strands that always let loose, in exception for the braid that hung low by the side, though dirtied in blood and debris now.

Broad shoulders. Strong frame. Crimson lines across open skin that he revered every cycle.

His jaw trembled violently as he forced a sound through a throat scorched raw.

“Y… Y-You— …”

His voice cracked apart.

Not human anymore.

Something fractured instead.

Was he even truly living anymore?

A gauntleted hand immediately cupped his face as his broken voice led away to a raspy exhale.

“Don’t speak… just stay. Stay with me. Stay with us.”

He couldn’t help but frown.

The deeper voice curled over him sounded devastated.

No. No, that tone should not exist anymore.

There shouldn’t be any touch of despair.

No pain, no agony, no sadness.

So why…?

He tried to continue breathing, keeping his heart steady somehow. However, before he could even try, the agony nearly eclipsed thought itself, barely handled by his experience full of more than a million years.

“M-Myd— … ei…”

This time, the word, his name, came out barely audible.

But, the man heard it instantly.

“I’m here.”

Both of his hands cradled his face carefully now, finally starting to tremble.

“I’m right here. Stay. Deliverer, stay.”

Stay.

Stay.

He wanted to.

Titans, he wanted to.

For once, just once, he wanted to stay.

No more blood. No more death. No more cycles.

No more.

He just wanted the chance to be able to show around Aedes Elysiae. To dance with everyone under the true sun, where smiles could be shared without another care in the world.

He wanted to be there and be chastised by Aglaea regarding his fashion choices for his clothing.

He wanted to hear Tribbie call him, “Snowy!” with the bright grin of hers.

He wanted to have the honor of getting to hug Castorice without her curse.

He wanted to get reprimanded by Anaxa in a debate between the two of them.

He wanted to listen to Hyacine laugh joyfully and talk about herself.

He wanted to banter with Cipher when the weight of the world wasn't on their shoulders.

He wanted to get to know both Cerydra and Hysilens better and make up for the cycles they could not.

He wanted to truly meet March and take her around Marmoreal Market for her scrapbook.

He wanted to allow Dan Heng to regale his tales and knowledge to him without a disturbance.

He wanted the Trailblazer, his partner, to show him the world and the cosmos outside of Amphoreus.

He wanted mornings beside Mydei where they could abide by peaceful days. A moment where they would not have to fight for their lives. A second of solitude together.

A heartbeat.

Just a heartbeat with him.

He wanted…

Wanted—

The thought collapsed midway through its formation.

Something inside him split open completely, and his vision suddenly darkened around the edges.

The world tilted violently as his hearing vanished deeper and deeper into ringing static. He could no longer feel his own heartbeat properly, if the weakening pounding said anything at all.

Panic flickered weakly through him, the only indication being the shuddering hitch in his breath.

What would happen to him soon?

Would he disappear?

Would he become nothing?

Would he cease to no longer exist?

No thought, no feeling, nothing at all?

The fear should have terrified him. Maybe even rage should've followed in pursuit of the unfairness of this all.

Hadn't he given everything?

What more did this universe want from him?

Instead, exhaustion swallowed almost everything else.

He was so tired.

So impossibly tired.

Millions of cycles crashed through him all at once, and for once in his unyielding life, he let the collapse fester.

His body visibly sagged against Mydei's arms, and in turn, those hands steadied him and held on with a terrified grip. Even more than before.

The others were speaking. Talking. Cry